Mehta turned to him and said, ‘Why don’t you stop being a policeman and start doing something useful? We have a post of Deputy General Manager in ICICI consequent on the promotion of Mr. H.T. Parekh. We can consider you for that post if you are interested…’ Raj was taken by surprise given that he knew nothing of either banking or development banking. But Mehta brushed his objections aside saying he was sure something could be worked out. Something was worked out and to Raj’s amazement, within four months, he found himself as Deputy General Manager of ICICI. Raj described the years that followed, as the happiest period of his life. ‘There was the excitement of building up a new institution under the leadership of G.L. and H.T. Parekh, who made an admirable team, each of whom had human qualities, which endeared them to the entire staff. My years in ICICI appeared to me to be no work at all, such was the cheerful atmosphere and the excitement of learning new things.’[6]

Many years later, Phiroze Medhora, who was the Joint Managing Director, noted the change in ICICI’s management style when he observed, ‘Before I joined ICICI, I had heard of ICICI essentially as a frosty, upper-class organization: it was selective, formal and acted superior to its clients. When I joined ICICI in 1960, this image of ICICI was confirmed as prevailing before 1958. However, by 1960 ICICI had been established as a humane, sympathetic development bank, willing to encourage new entrepreneurs to take risks. Credit is due to two persons—G.L. Mehta and H.T. Parekh—for bringing about this transformation.’[7] ‘He instituted a sense of values amongst us, not by instruction, but by example. His management style was marked by large-heartedness and human considerations,’ recalled S.S. Nadkarni who became ICICI’s sixth Chairman in 1984 and later was also Chairman of IDBI.[8] Parekh himself was aware of the challenges before them and the need for a group of like-minded professionals. ‘Managing a development corporation with the right kind of public image, non-bureaucratic, friendly and helpful, is possible only with a suitable band of professional colleagues who share a positive desire to serve, attract, and encourage new entrepreneurs and are ready and willing to take reasonable risks. ICICI grew impressively to gain acceptance of the Indian business community, recognition of government, and even became a showpiece for the World Bank.’[9] ‘HTP stood for financing new entrepreneurs long before venture capital became a slogan’ said Nadkarni.[10]